

MANISH RAJPUT

NILANJAN BHOWAL, 57

Architect

"Breathing in the fresh air, the smell of the wet earth, the sight of birds in the sky and the sound of a flowing stream—being at one with nature makes me the most happy. I am happiest in the hills, where nature is still pristine and untouched by development. In the hills, the air is still pure and I can feel it fill up my lungs. I love taking long walks in the pinewood forests, surrounded by chirping birds. I also want to give back to nature, and not only take from it. This is what drives me, designing small habitats where people can stay in harmony and consonance with nature."

AMRUTA FADNAVIS, 43

Singer, banker

"Happiness, I feel, is a state of mind. There are external factors that make you happy, but you have to find happiness within first. That will help you absorb the external happiness better. There are many external factors, but for me, the best reason to make myself happy is to see happiness in the eyes of those around me. Happiness is also the greatest form of success that you can experience in life. Being with my daughter, touching those notes perfectly when I sing during *riyaz*, and seeing smiles on the faces of those who have benefited from the work done through my NGOs—all these things make me happy."



MANDAR DEODHAR



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ANUKRTI UPADHYAY, 48

Poet, writer

"Autumn light. Sky the soft hue of a blue jay's wing. Colours ripening in the woods on the slopes of a mountain. A yellow bloom in the green bedewed grass. The mild cold smell of the oncoming season. Brown fragrant slow-brewed coffee in a tall glass. Birds, squirrels, falling leaves. A book, a slice of time, quietude. An interval for silence, solitude, sequestration. Joy flows through many channels and seeps away from innumerable cracks. But for me, it has one perennial source—to sit amongst nature with my own self and look inside, root around, unearth, discover. In the external stillness, come the clamouring words. In the everyday business of life, these liminal spaces are where true joy—the* anand *that has no form or feature and is purely experiential—happens."